

Freescale releases reference design for under-\$200 smartbooks

Freescale has unveiled what could become the future of the smartbook category, showcasing a tablet reference design with a 17.7 cm (7 inch) touch screen with up to four times the viewing area of a typical smartphone. It is based on a form factor that is approximately one-third the size and volume of today's notebooks. Details of the reference design are available at www.freescale.com/smartbook and it is expected to be available for evaluation beginning February 2010.

The solution is based on the Freescale i.MX515 processor that incorporates the ARM Cortex-A8 technology. It also includes Freescale MC13892 power management IC, SGTL5000 audio codec and MMA8450Q 3-axis accelerometer. The Freescale tablet includes Wi-Fi and Bluetooth wireless connectivity and features a 3D desktop framework with touchscreen/QWERTY keyboard support. Options for a 3G modem and RF4CE protocol are available.

The solution will enable a second generation of smartbook products priced below \$200 and featuring form factors that fully leverage the power, performance and functionality of advanced ARM processor technology. It is designed to provide instant-on functionality, persistent connectivity and all-day battery life. The tablet was demonstrated at the 2010 Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas in January, running both the Android and other Linux operating systems.

Get an Ubuntu netbook for Rs 13,999

Simmtronics Semiconductors has signed a global deal with IBM as part of which IBM has authorised Simmtronics to pre-load its *IBM Client for Smart Work* software solution in its Simmbook that runs Ubuntu. This includes

Lotus Symphony office productivity software. Under the agreement, both the companies will execute a joint marketing plan and work closely on the sales opportunities for Simmbook with IBM

Client for Smart Work on Ubuntu, globally.

Priced at Rs 13,999, the Simmbook is now available in India through the company's 16 direct sales offices. The netbook is powered by a 1.6 GHz Intel Atom processor and Intel Generation 3.5 Integrated GFZ Core Graphic VGA. It comes in a black, blue and red colour chassis, with a 25.9 cm (10.2 inch) LCD screen and 1024 X 600 pixel resolution. Other device specs include: 160 GB SATA HDD, 1GB DDR2 667MHz RAM, a 1.3 MP camera, a 3-in-1 MMC/SD/MS/MS Pro card reader, and three USB 2.0 ports. It weighs about 1.2 kg with a three-cell battery pack. For more details, visit www.simmtronics.com/simmbook.php.



French govt to citizens: Stop using Internet Explorer

The French government has issued an advisory to computer users, recommending that they switch to a different Web browser, such as Firefox or Google Chrome. France's move follows that of the German government, which recently discovered that Internet Explorer contained a dangerous security flaw that could be exploited by cyber criminals.

Microsoft admitted that its Internet Explorer 6 browser was the weak link in recent attacks that cracked into e-mail accounts of human rights activists in China. But it said that the German government had gone too far in its over-reaction, and that general users were not at risk. But that did not stop the French government issuing a bulletin through Certe, a government agency responsible for managing and protecting against cyber threats. The bulletin said that all versions of Internet Explorer were affected by the security flaw, and suggested people use an alternative browser.

New Pardus out!

Pardus Linux 2009.1 comes with the latest stable KDE release, enhanced hardware support, and a bigger software archive with up-to-date packages such as KDE 4.3.4, Linux kernel 2.6.31.11, OpenOffice.org 3.1.1, Mozilla Firefox 3.5.7, the GIMP 2.6.8, X.Org Server 1.6.5, Python 2.6.4 and many more, in just one

CD. With the 2009.1 series, the Pardus ISO files are generated as hybrid images, which can be burned to a CD, DVD or dumped to a hard disk-like media, such as a USB stick.

